Narendra Modi's Foreign Policy

Modi's Middle East policy

- India's bold outreach to Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates.

- For far too long, the Persian Gulf did not receive the attention it deserved. Many countries there were viewed as overly supportive of Pakistan for religious reasons and hence left outside of India's priorities

- Recognising, however, the political changes in the Arab world, Modi moved unexpectedly to engage Saudi Arabia and the UAE in ways that promise important political and economic benefits.

- The weakening of the traditional, knee-jerk support for Pakistan is already in evidence, but the longer-term gains derive from the Gulf monarchies' deepening opposition to Islamist terrorism as India continues to struggle against this threat.

- The growing interest in India as an economic opportunity further suggests that the wealthy Arab states will increasingly acquire a stake in New Delhi's success.

- India already remains a major customer of Gulf energy, but as India rises internationally, it will become more important to the region's strategic interests.

- Modi's ability to begin this transformation, while avoiding entanglement with the current intra-Gulf rivalries and while preserving good relations with Iran, demonstrates an agility that has eluded even the United States.

- India controls Chabahar port

- Iran Vs Saudi
- Saudi vs Yemen
- Syria vs Saudi
- Syria is supported by Iran
- Turkey vs Saudi
- Iran vs Turkey

Order of Zayed

Order of King Abdulaziz Al Saud

Modi and Israel

- In 2017, Modi became the first Indian prime minister to visit Israel, which was reciprocated months later when Netanyahu travelled to Delhi.

- The narrative they were pushing was clear

- India and Israel are these ancient civilisations that had been derailed by outsiders – which means Muslims – and their leaders have come together, like long-lost brothers, to fulfil their destiny.

"All the News That's Fit to Print"

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, partly sunny, breezy, cool, high 58. Tonight, clouds, low 52. Tomorrow, not as breezy and warmer, a morning shower, partly sunny, high 65. Weather map, Page B6.

VOL. CLXXIII .... No. 59,936 © 2023 The New York Times Company MONDAY, OCTOBER 9, 2023 Prices in Canada may be higher $4.00

CAUGHT OFF GUARD, ISRAEL FIGHTS BACK

Missed Warning Signs and Slow Responses

This article is by Julian E. Barnes, David E. Sanger and Eric Schmitt.

WASHINGTON — The devastating surprise attack by Hamas on Saturday represented an equally stunning intelligence failure by Israel that involved undetected warnings, overwhelmed missile defenses and a slow response by apparently unprepared military forces, former and current U.S. officials said.

American officials said Hamas had achieved a complete tactical surprise, reflected in a death toll of at least 700 Israelis. The Palestinian militant group sent hundreds of fighters through breached walls, breaking through with bulldozers and then killing civilians and soldiers in shooting sprees that went on for hours.

None of Israel's intelligence services had specific warning that Hamas was preparing a sophisticated attack that required coordinated land, air and sea strikes, according to an Israeli defense official and American officials.

The success astounded American officials with experience in the region. Over the years, Israel has set up a network of electronic intercepts, sensors and human informants throughout Gaza, which is about half the area of New York's five boroughs. Israel and its neighbors have in the past invested heavily in trying to track and block Hamas's networks, often intercepting shipments of missile components.

That past success has made all the more urgent a series of questions about Israel's failures on Saturday.

Why was Israel's Iron Dome missile defense system, now a dozen years old, apparently overwhelmed by the barrage of inexpensive but deadly missiles at the opening of the attack? How did Hamas manage to build such a big arsenal of rockets and missiles without Israeli intelligence detecting the growing stockpile?

Was Israel too focused on threats from Hezbollah and the West Bank, rather than focusing military and intelligence resources on Gaza? And why were so many Israeli forces on leave or distant from the southern border, allowing Hamas to overrun Israeli military bases near Gaza?

Neither American nor Israeli officials would address the questions on Sunday. But clearly the answers could affect the reputation of Israel's military and intelli-

At a Dance and a Kibbutz, Attackers Slipped In and Unleashed Horror

This article is by Patrick Kingsley, Aaron Boxerman and Gabby Sobelman.

BEERSHEBA, Israel — The thousands of young Israelis had spent the night dancing at an outdoor rave, many clad in tie-dyed T-shirts and crop tops.

They ended the night in a massacre.

Just after dawn on Saturday, hundreds of Palestinian militants bulldozed their way through the barricades between Gaza and Israel, drove into scores of Israeli towns along the border and sped through the farmland where the rave was reaching its sunrise climax.

The militants gunned down more than 100 ravers and abducted others, according to two senior Israeli officials, as they sprinted through the open fields. Video verified by The New York Times showed militants driving off on a motorcycle with an Israeli woman squeezed between them, screaming as her boyfriend was marched off on foot, his arm wrenched behind his back.

Those who survived often did so by hiding in nearby bushes, some of them for hours.

Bullets whistled overhead and shots resounded all around, said Andrey Pearlie, 35, one of the survivors. He described crawling up to the top of a nearby hill to get a better sense of what was happening.

"Smoke and flames and gunfire," said Mr. Pearlie, a tech worker. "I have a military background, but I never was in a situation like this."

So began one of the bloodiest weekends in Israeli and Palestinian history, the full details of which started to emerge on Sunday as survivors recounted the most complex and brazen attack on their nation since the 1973 Arab-Israeli war.

About 700 Israelis were killed and at least 150 taken hostage by Palestinian militants, according to a preliminary assessment shared by a senior Israeli military official. Videos circulated of children and grandparents abducted from their homes in Israel and roadsides strewn with dead bodies. A National Security Council spokesperson said Sunday that "several" American citizens had been killed in the fighting.

The assault, staggering in its scale, prompted a fierce counterattack from Israel that has killed more than 400 Gazans in missile strikes and gun battles, according

Bullet holes in a police car on Sunday in Sderot, near Gaza.

to Gazan health officials.

The violence began familiarly enough — with rocket fire from Gaza, just after dawn.

Amir Tibon and his neighbors in Kibbutz Nahal Oz, a village that stands a few hundred yards from Gaza, have become accustomed to frequent rocket fire from militants.

Bomb shelters are installed in every home in the kibbutz, and residents are used to rushing inside them every few weeks.

But soon after Mr. Tibon, 35, took shelter on Saturday with his wife and two young daughters, he knew that there was something

Continued on Page A8

NEWS ANALYSIS

'Shaken to the Core,' Israelis Question the Nation's Security

By ROGER COHEN

The most sweeping invasion of Israeli territory in decades, conducted by a Hamas force that had been widely seen as a ragtag collection of militants, has delivered a psychological shock in

Yom Kippur War. But 75 years, and a half-century, respectively, from those conflicts, the sight of villages once again overrun, hostages seized and desperate civilians being killed by Palestin-

"All the News That's Fit to Print"

The New York Times

LATE EDITION
Today, partly sunny and breezy, cooler, high 60. Tonight, some clouds, low 50. Tomorrow, breezy with clouds and sunshine, high 59. Weather map appears on Page 23.

VOL. CLXXIII ... No. 59,935 © 2023 The New York Times Company NEW YORK, SUNDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2023 $6.00

PALESTINIAN MILITANTS STAGE ATTACK ON ISRAEL

MORNING BARRAGE A group of rockets fired from Gaza City sailed toward Israel.

EARLY CASUALTIES Bodies of Israelis killed by militants in the city of Sderot.

CARRYING THE DEAD Mourners in Gaza City lifted the body of a slain militant.

BREAKING THROUGH Palestinians breaching the border fence with southern Israel.

Assault Met With Big Strikes on Gaza Cities

By PATRICK KINGSLEY and ISABEL KERSHNER

JERUSALEM — Israel battled on Saturday to repel one of the broadest invasions of its territory in 50 years after Palestinian militants from Gaza launched an early-morning assault on southern Israel, infiltrating 22 Israeli towns and army bases, kidnapping Israeli civilians and soldiers and firing thousands of rockets toward cities as far away as Jerusalem.

By early evening, the Israeli military said fighting continued in at least five places in southern Israel; multiple Israelis had been abducted and taken to Gaza, including an elderly grandmother; and at least 250 Israelis had been reported dead by officials and more than 1,600 wounded. Israel retaliated with huge strikes on Gazan cities, and the Gaza Health Ministry said at least 234 Palestinians had been killed in either gun battles or airstrikes.

In an assault without recent precedent in its complexity and scale, the militants crossed into Israel by land, sea and air, according to the Israeli military, leading to some of the first pitched battles between Israeli and Arab forces on Israeli soil in decades.

Unverified video footage, circulated by Hamas, the Iran-backed militant group that controls the Gaza Strip, appeared to show some Palestinian gunmen arriving in Israel in a sort of makeshift hang glider.

Residents of Israeli border towns told broadcasters that gunmen were moving door to door, looking for civilians. Unverified footage appeared to show Palestinian fighters transporting captured Israeli civilians and bodies through the strip — to be bargained, analysts said, for Palestinian prisoners.

In Sderot, a southern city, photographs showed dead bodies strewn on the streets. The militants also targeted an all-night dance festival in the desert, prompting hundreds of young Israelis to sprint for safety.

"We are at war and we will win it," Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu of Israel said in a televised statement, announcing a call-up of hundreds of thousands of Israeli military reservists.

Continued on Page 12

BLOW TO BIDEN The attacks are likely to slow progress toward an Israel-Saudi deal. PAGE 14

Migrant Influx Strains Support Of New Yorkers

By JOHN LELAND

Carin Bail said she was walking with a friend in Queens this spring when they stopped to talk with a woman who was holding a baby and crying. The woman had just arrived at a nearby migrant shelter, she explained in Spanish, and her baby would not eat the food there.

Ms. Bail bought the woman baby food and diapers. "What tugged at my heartstrings," she said, "was she had a kid with her."

Yet Ms. Bail, who teaches special education and yoga in public school, opposes the migrant shelters, and has spoken at rallies against them. She complained of

'The Children Were Terrified': Blasts and Gunmen at the Door

By ISABEL KERSHNER and RAJA ABDULRAHIM

JERUSALEM — Israeli citizens, barricaded in their homes in towns near the Gaza Strip, called into television stations as Palestinian gunmen crossed the border into Israel and invaded their communities on Saturday morning. The Israelis spoke in whispers as they pleaded desperately for help.

One woman named Doreen told Israel's Channel 12 that militants were in her house in Nahal Oz, a small rural community, and that she was hiding in a safe room. "My husband is holding the door of the bomb shelter," she said. "Now they're shooting sprays of bullets at the bomb shelter's window. Sprays. And my three children are here with me."

On the other side of the border in Gaza, Jamila Al-Zanin, 39, tried to distract her own three children as they fled their home and drove south.

"The children were terrified. As we drove down they were looking left and right, everywhere there were explosions and booms," she said. "They were hysterical."

"This is the first time in our history something like this has happened," she added, referring to the Palestinian attack.

Panic, disbelief and fear rippled throughout Israel and Gaza, as Palestinian militants on Saturday morning caught Israel off guard with a broad and coordinated

Continued on Page 13

As Netanyahu Speaks of War, The Question Is, 'What Then?'

By STEVEN ERLANGER

NEWS ANALYSIS

BERLIN — Nearly 50 years to the day after the Yom Kippur war of 1973, Israel has again been taken by surprise by a sudden attack, a startling reminder that stability in the Middle East remains a bloody mirage.

Unlike the series of clashes with Palestinian forces in Gaza over the last three years, this appears to be a full-scale conflict mounted by Hamas and its allies, with rocket barrages and incursions into Israel proper, and with Israelis killed and captured.

The psychological impact on Israelis has been compared to the shock of Sept. 11 in America.

So after the Israeli military repels the initial Palestinian attack, the question of what to do next will loom large. There are few good options for Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, who has declared war and is being pressured into a major military response.

Given that 250 Israelis have died so far and an unknown number been taken hostage by Hamas, an Israeli invasion of Gaza — and even a temporary reoccupation of the territory, something that successive Israeli governments have tried hard to avoid — cannot be ruled out.

As Mr. Netanyahu told Israelis

Continued on Page 11

- Modi strongly supported Israel in the Israel Palestine conflict
- India buys about $2bn-worth of arms from Israel every year – its largest arms supplier after Russia

Narendra Modi
@narendramodi

Deeply shocked by the news of terrorist attacks in Israel. Our thoughts and prayers are with the innocent victims and their families. We stand in solidarity with Israel at this difficult hour.

4:44 PM · Oct 7, 2023 · 27.9M Views

Grand Collar of the state of Palestine Award

Narendra Modi @naren... · 10 Feb 18

Friendship between India and Palestine has stood the test of time. The people of Palestine have shown remarkable courage in the face of several challenges. India will always support Palestine's development journey.

670 4,030 12.2K

Narendra Modi @naren... · 10 Feb 18

Replying to @narendramodi

I am glad that India and Palestine are cooperating extensively in key sectors such as technology, training and infrastructure development.

175 1,490 6,130

Russia Ukraine Conflict

Evacuation – Operation Ganga

HT
ZELENSKY DIALS PM MODI;
WANTS HELP OVER UKRAINE

TIMES NOW | India

Latest News **India** Business Elections 2022

PM Modi speaks to Russian President Putin, appeals for cessation of violence

Russia-Ukraine crisis: PM Modi called for concerted efforts from all sides to return to the path of diplomatic negotiations and dialogue.

Updated Feb 24, 2022 | 11:22 PM IST

Prime Minister Narendra Modi at the CCS meeting on the Ukraine crisis

HT
MEXICO WANTS PM MODI'S
MEDIATION IN RUSSIA-UKRAINE WAR

- It has abstained from successive votes in the UN Security Council, General Assembly, and Human Rights Council that condemned Russian aggression in Ukraine and thus far has refused to openly call out Russia as the instigator of the crisis.

- India's public neutrality toward the Russian invasion is driven fundamentally by its concerns vis-à-vis China and Pakistan.

- India has a durable view of Russia as a "dependable partner."

- India's continuing dependence on Russia for military equipment only deepens its reluctance to alienate Moscow in any way.

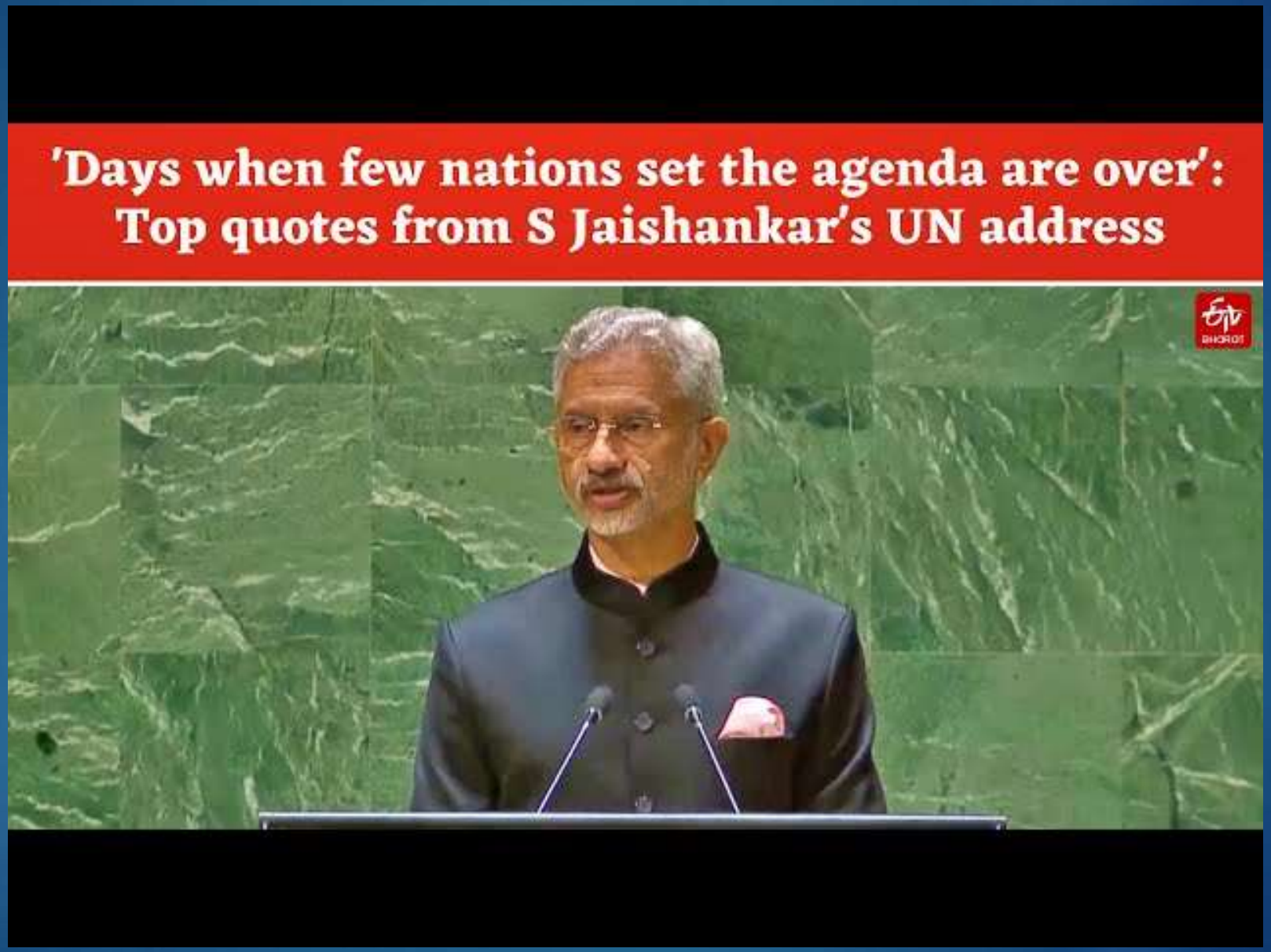
- India has begun to diversify its arms purchases away from Russia during the last two decades, Russia still remains a critical — and, in fact, it is necessary even for the maintenance and repairing.

HT
THAROOR PRAISES INDIA'S
STAND ON RUSSIA-UKRAINE WAR

HT
JAISHANKAR CALLS OUT WESTERN
'HYPOCRISY' ON RUSSIAN OIL

A US Journalist Asked,
"Why India Is Still Buying Oil From Russia Amid The Sanctions."

Indian External Affairs Minister Dr. S. Jaishankar Replied- "India's Total Monthly Purchase Of Oil From Russia Is Probably Less Than What Europe Does In An Afternoon."


'Days when few nations set the agenda are over':
Top quotes from S Jaishankar's UN address

“India Is Entitled To Make Its Own Choices.”
Dr. S Jaishankar
www.success-trending.club

Modi's policy towards Pakistan

- Modi surprised everyone with his first major foreign policy initiative even before he took over as Prime Minister — inviting the heads of government of all SAARC countries for his swearing-in ceremony.

- The widely held perception at that time was that this was a cover for reaching out to Pakistan.

- From picking up the phone to convey Ramzan greetings, walking up to Nawaz Sharif in Paris, his impromptu visit to Lahore, allowing a Pakistani investigating team to visit the Pathankot air base to investigate the terror attack by Pakistani terrorists, if there is anything Modi cannot be faulted for, it is that he tried his best to improve relations with Pakistan.

THE TIMES OF INDIA

NOW, FLASHPOINT DDCA: KEJRI SAYS LG WON'T LET HIS GOVT WORK 2

TURKISH PRESIDENT ERDOGAN TALKS MAN OUT OF SUICIDE 16

STYLE ICON OF THE SIXTIES AND BOX-OFFICE QUEEN SADHANA DIES AT 74 8

After landing in Kabul from Moscow, Modi calls Sharif to wish him Happy Birthday. Sharif says, why don't you drop by since you'll be flying home over my country? Modi readily agrees

In A Dramatically Spontaneous Gesture, Nawaz Becomes 1st PM Since Vajpayee In 2004 To Visit Pak, Then Too Led By Sharif. Can His Unorthodox Brand Of Diplomacy Lead To Lasting Peace?

THREE BIRTHDAYS, A WEDDING & ANOTHER HONEYMOON

What Modi didn't know when he called Sharif to wish him on his birthday was that it was also the day the Pakistani PM's granddaughter was getting married. It also happened to be the birthday of Vajpayee & Ilonah

- PM leaves Moscow on Thursday night, arrives before dawn in Kabul
- Breakfast meeting with Afghan president Ashraf Ghani at Dilkusha Palace at 10.30am. Discusses security, bilateral cooperation
- Around 11.30am, inaugurates Afghan Parliament building constructed by India; also opens 'Atal Block', named after Vajpayee
- Makes two veiled references to Pak: 'There are some who didn't want us to be here'; 'Afghanistan will succeed only when terrorism no longer flows across the border'
- Reaches Lahore around 5pm. Received by Sharif with a warm hug. Then take copter to Sharif's ancestral home Raiwind Palace in Jati Umra where his granddaughter's wedding is on
- Leaves Lahore for Delhi around 7.30pm

HAND IN HAND, STEP BY STEP: Nawaz Sharif receives Modi at Lahore airport on Friday

"THAT'S LIKE A STATESMAN. PAGOSI SE AISE HI RISHTE NONE CHAHYEN"
— Foreign minister SUSHMA SWARAJ responding to Modi's travel on Lahore stopover

"SPENT A WARM EVENING WITH SHARIF FAMILY AT THEIR FAMILY HOME. NAWAZ SAHAB'S BIRTHDAY & GRANDDAUGHTER'S MARRIAGE MADE IT A DOUBLE CELEBRATION"
— PM MODI

LAHORE SURPRISE
Pages 12, 14 & 15
▶ Modi approach frivolous, unpredictable: Cong, P 14

Mix of impulse, strategy drove PM's decision

Indrani Bagchi
dilmeng@mail.com

How did PM Narendra Modi, supposed to only do Moscow and Kabul, end up in Lahore?

After his address in the new Afghan Parliament, a speech which Hamid Karzai, Afghanistan's president till 2014, hit the PM brought tears to 36 million countrymen, Modi got into his car and dialled Nawaz Sharif to wish him on his birthday. Sharif informed Modi he was not in Islamabad but in Lahore to attend his granddaughter's wedding.

Sharif then invited Modi over "Since you would be flying over my country anyway why don't you drop by?"

Modi, acting on a rare of impulse and strategy, agreed to stop over for tea with the Pakistan PM, leaving the Indian delegation as well as the security set up stunned.

In Islamabad, Indian high commissioner TCA Raghavan, who was enjoying a lazy Christmas day, suddenly found he had not over three hours to get to Lahore to greet his PM. Sharif, what has

200 barriers to be set up for odd-even plan

Cops: Challans Unlikely During Peak Hours

Somrani Bhattacharya
dilmeng@mail.com

New Delhi: The traffic police plan to set up special barriers and conduct checks at intersections to book violators of the odd-even rule for private four wheelers to be tried during January 1-15 but admit they are hopeless in understaffed, for such a massive operation, particularly during rush hours.

Policemen backing up the government contention that fail to follow the road rationing rule, aimed at reducing air pollution levels, through public complaints.

Police would set up about 150 more barriers across the city, similar to what is done for events such as Republic Day. On normal days, the force operates around 50 check posts. The 15 barrier posts would also be manned by policemen to stop vehicles from entering the city.

With the additional barriers, traffic movement is expected to be slow but cops said they were working on streamlining the flow. For instance, no random checks would be conducted, as it may lead to snarls on arterial roads at peak hours.

▶ Continued on P 2

PULL COVERAGE: P 3

NUMBER CHECKS

Cops to have far odd-even violators at

- 200 barricades across city, including 23 border points. Usually, there are 50
- 700 traffic signals
- MCD parking lots
- Petrol pumps
- Around markets such as CP, Khan Market, Sarojini Nagar, Lajpat Nagar

GETTING READY

- 50 bike patrol teams to be deployed at junctions
- 6 smaller machines to be tweaked to enable prosecutions

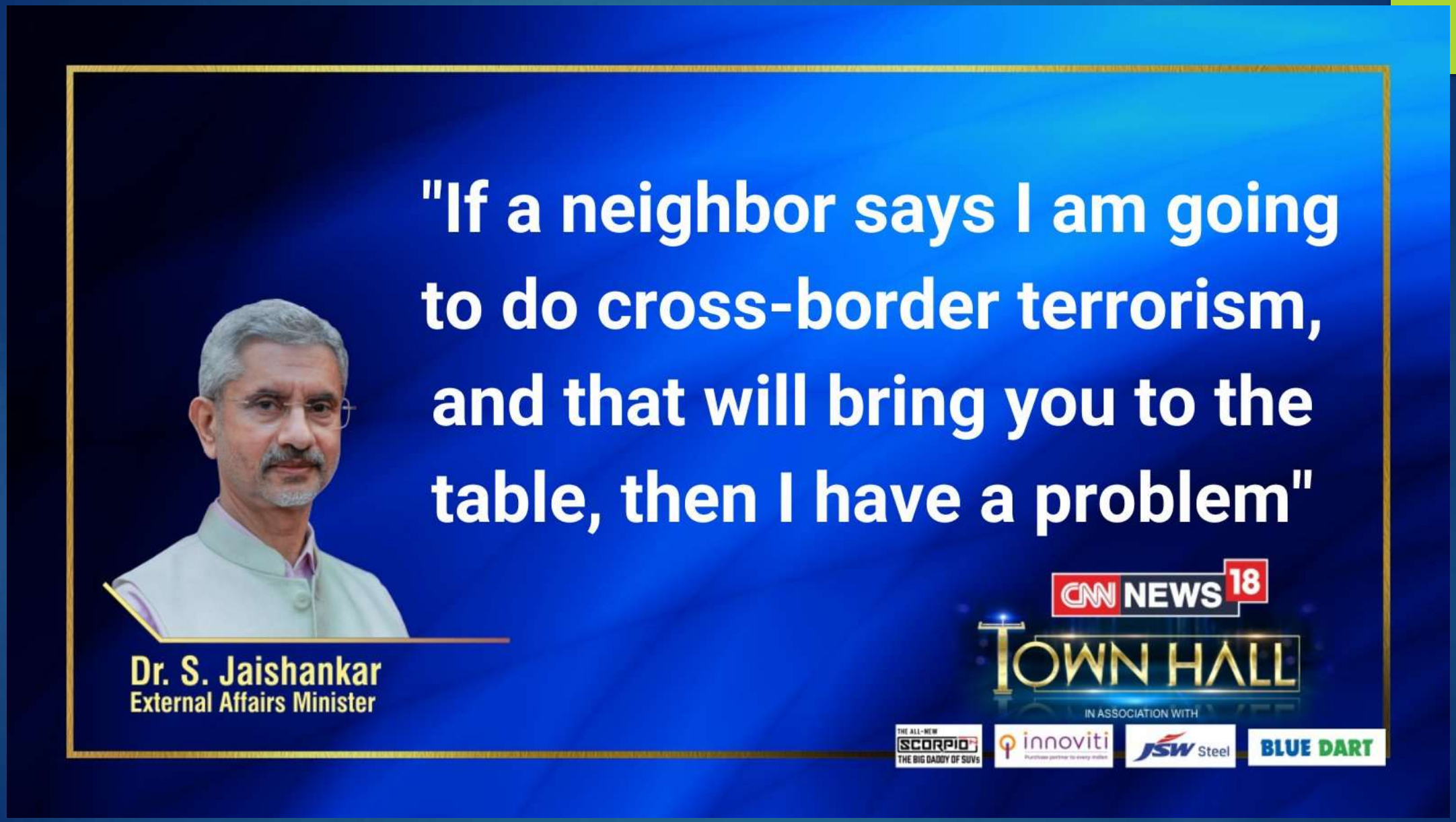
OBCs hold just 12% of central govt jobs

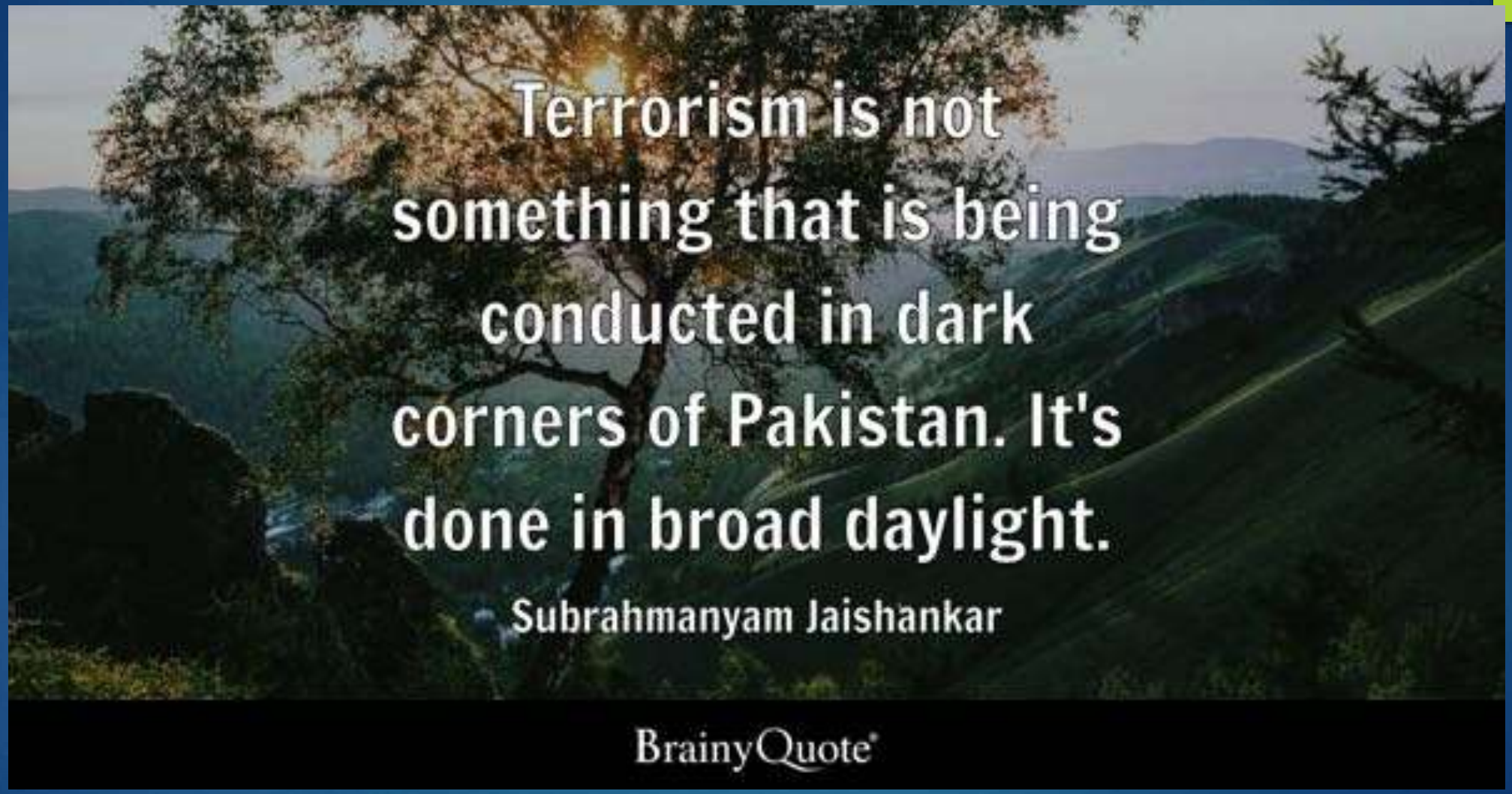
- The Uri terror attack in which nearly 20 soldiers were killed was the last straw.
- Modi knew that his credibility as a leader was at stake and not doing anything — his predecessors had mastered the art of retaliating by threatening to retaliate, and then piping down — was no longer an option.
- The element of uncertainty that has been introduced by the surgical strikes means that the Pakistanis are suddenly not quite sure of India's reaction to any provocation from their side.

- At the diplomatic level, India has become proactive to increase the pressure on Pakistan.
- Every available international forum is now being used to show Pakistan for what it is — a terror-sponsoring country.
- At the bilateral level, the government seems to have woken up to the fiction of people-to-people contacts as a way to normalise ties.
-
- This means a very restricted visa policy, no bilateral cricket, no IPL, no fat contracts in Bollywood, and so on and so forth.
- For the first time India has started dealing with Pakistan in a language and in a manner that neither the Pakistanis nor their Indian lackeys ever expected from an Indian government.

At the UN General Assembly
Duniya me aise desh hai
jo bote bhi hai toh
aatankwaad,
ugaate bhi hai toh
aatankwaad,
bechte bhi hai toh
aatankwaad,
niryaat bhi karte hai toh
aatankwaad
scrolldroll.com

mid-day
WILL NEVER ALLOW
TERRORISM
TO FORCE INDIA
TO NEGOTIATING TABLE
–S JAISHANKAR


"If a neighbor says I am going to do cross-border terrorism, and that will bring you to the table, then I have a problem"
Dr. S. Jaishankar
External Affairs Minister
CNN NEWS 18
TOWN HALL
IN ASSOCIATION WITH
THE ALL-NEW SCORPIO
THE BIG DADDY OF SUVs
innoviti
JSW Steel
BLUE DART


Terrorism is not something that is being conducted in dark corners of Pakistan. It's done in broad daylight.
Subrahmanyam Jaishankar
BrainyQuote

India Canada Relations

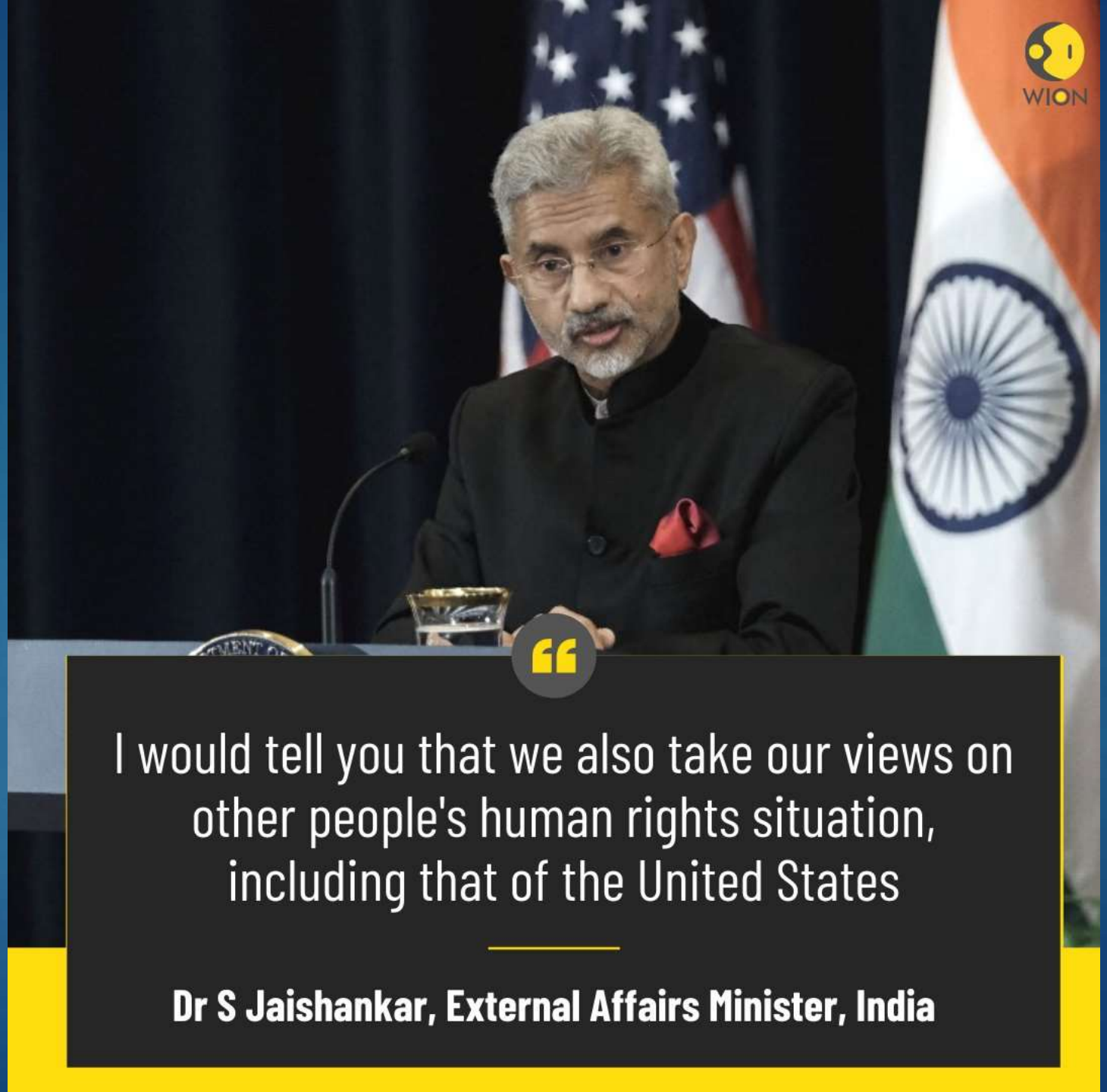
- India-Canada ties—historically driven by trade and the presence of a large Indian diaspora in Canada—have slowly deteriorated in recent years.

- Because of claims from India that Canada has fostered sympathy toward a Sikh separatist movement, and counter-claims from Canada accusing Indian officials of interfering in its domestic politics.

- The relationship hit rock bottom on when Trudeau made an explosive allegation that India assassinated a prominent Sikh Canadian leader, Hardeep Singh Nijjar, on Canadian soil in June.
- The Canadian government expelled a senior Indian diplomat shortly after Trudeau's comments.
- S. Jaishankar, warned during a press conference that Canada giving space to Sikh separatists "was not good for the relationship" between the two countries.
- India had even temporarily stopped Visa Services to the Canadians

"EUROPE'S PROBLEMS ARE WORLD'S PROBLEMS BUT WORLD'S PROBLEMS ARE NOT EUROPE'S?"

-Dr. S JAISHANKAR
External Affairs Minister, India


WION
I would tell you that we also take our views on other people's human rights situation, including that of the United States
Dr S Jaishankar, External Affairs Minister, India

INDIA TODAY
No major issue in the world is decided without some consultation with India. We have changed and the world's view of us has changed.
S Jaishankar
External Affairs Minister of India